

Co- Regulation

Your Guide to Staying Calm Together.



Mumma Chelles

Co-Regulation: Your Guide to Staying Calm Together

What is Co-Regulation?

Co-regulation is the warm, supportive process where a calm adult helps a child navigate their big emotions. It's not about "fixing" their feelings, but about being a steady anchor in their emotional storm. By lending them our calm, we teach them how to find it for themselves.

"Co-regulation is the process through which caregivers, such as parents or teachers, support a child in managing their emotions and responses to stress. This concept goes beyond merely calming a child. Instead, it's about establishing a foundation for self-regulation."

— Arzeen Cooper Boyd, OT

Why Does It Matter?

Children, especially young children, don't have the brain wiring to calm themselves down from big feelings. They learn to self-regulate by first co-regulating with a trusted adult. This process builds resilience, emotional intelligence, and a secure, trusting relationship.

The Co-Regulation Toolkit

1. Check Your Own Weather First

Before you can calm your child, you need to find your own calm. Emotions are contagious.

Take a deep breath. Put your hand on your heart. Remind yourself: "This is not an emergency."

2. The PAUSE Framework

When your child's emotional storm hits, remember to PAUSE:

- **Pause:** Don't react immediately. Take a breath.
- **Acknowledge the Feeling:** "You are so angry right now." "This is really hard."
- **Understand the Need:** What is the feeling underneath the behaviour? Are they tired, hungry, overwhelmed?
- **Support, Don't Solve:** Get down on their level. Offer a hug or just your quiet presence.
- **Empower:** Once calm, you can talk about what happened and what they can do next time.

3. Co-Regulation in Action: What to Say and Do

Age Group	What it Looks Like	What to Say
Babies	Rocking, swaddling, humming, skin-to-skin contact	"I'm right here with you." "You're safe."
Toddlers	Getting down on their level, offering a hug, using a calm voice	"I see you're having a hard time." "Let's breathe together."
Children	Offering a quiet space, a weighted blanket, or a calming activity	"It's okay to be angry. It's not okay to hit people or to break things. Let's punch this pillow instead."
Teens	Offering a drink of water, a walk, or just sitting with them in silence	"This is really tough. I'm here for you." "I'm not going to leave you alone with this feeling."

Remember: It's a Dance, Not a Formula

Some children will want a hug; others will need space. The key is to observe your child and adjust your approach. Your consistent, loving presence is the most powerful tool you have.

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This resource is for informational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice. Please consult with a qualified professional for any concerns you may have.

Co-Regulation: Your Guide to Staying Calm...

Co-regulation is one of the most powerful gifts we can offer children. By staying calm and connected during big emotions, you are helping build the foundation for lifelong emotional resilience, safety, and trust.

Remember - progress happens in small moments. Every pause, every deep breath, every moment of connection matters.

Thank you for being committed to supporting your child's emotional world.

For more resources, tools, and support, explore the work of [Mumma Chelles Sensory Insights](#).